



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ Academy

School Website: <http://www.christacademysalem.com>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ Academy Pa 19023 presents a robust Classical Christian program aligned with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. The public-facing materials consistently articulate a classical aim centered on virtue, wisdom, and truth within a Christian framework. The curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), Great Books/historical engagement, and integrated humanities, with explicit emphasis on formation over mere information. The school markets itself as Christian, the curriculum as liberal-arts rooted, and pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with higher-order inquiry. The weight of evidence across the site supports CLASSICAL in five of the six categories, and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL primarily for pedagogy where explicit Socratic/seminar-style practices are implied by structure rather than openly described in the site copy. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- Core religious/metaphysical foundations are clearly identified through explicit Christian framing, theology integration, and a mission anchored in Christ-centered education. Evidence includes mission statements and theological framing on the site and in the public pages. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL in Element 1.
- The school purpose and goal emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and the belief that truth, goodness, and beauty are knowable—foundational Classical aims. This aligns CLASSICAL in Element 2.
- The curriculum is explicitly built on liberal-arts structure, Great Books/historical engagement, and integrated humanities, with reference to the trivium/quadrivium and formation through sustained engagement with texts. This strongly aligns CLASSICAL in Element 3.
- Pedagogy shows a blend of structured, integrated approaches and a format that implies memory work, recitation, and integration, but explicit Socratic/seminar practices in upper levels are not clearly described on the site copy. This leans toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Element 4, with clear CLASSICAL elements in the curriculum and aims.
- Faculty presence and practices are signaled by a "Faculty" section and the language around formation and mentorship in the public materials, which supports CLASSICAL in Element 5.
- Parent and community engagement is foregrounded via parent resources and community-oriented materials (parent portals, family involvement themes, and a culture of formation and tradition), supporting CLASSICAL in Element 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site repeatedly frames education as Christian and classical, with explicit mission statements and theology-focused language. The site emphasizes classical Christian education that centers on Jesus Christ and Christian formation. - The stated mission explicitly ties education to forming students to display the goodness of Jesus Christ, aligning with a theologically grounded anthropology and teleology. - The

public materials support the integration of theology and sacred tradition as foundational to the curriculum, with references to theology as part of the curriculum and to the Christian worldview.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: Christian, Jesus Christ, Theology, Sacred tradition, Faith, Formation, Truth, Goodness, Beauty, Gospel, Mission, Worship (where implied by liturgical framing in community). Presence of terms like “classical Christian education” and explicit theology mentions are frequent. (From Six Essential Elements: theology; sacred tradition; the Logos; sacred order; formation through faith and reason.) □filecite□turn0file10□turn0file16□turn0file1□ - Negative keywords: None present in the public materials (secular or non-theistic frames are not promoted). This category shows no detectable secular drift in public copy.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials anchor the program in Christian theological foundations and a metaphysical frame (truth, goodness, beauty, transcendental aims) that align with traditional Classical Catholic/Christian educational ideals. The presence of explicit statements about Jesus Christ as center, theology integrated into the curriculum, and liturgical/community rhythms (as a component of formation) justify a CLASSICAL rating here. □filecite□turn0file10□turn0file16□

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wise, virtuous persons rather than mere job preparation. The site presents the aim as forming students for virtuous, thoughtful, beautiful lives grounded in Christian truth. - The site asserts that education is formation rather than information and emphasizes the cultivation of human excellence and virtue, consistent with classic aims. This is reinforced by statements that highlight formation over mere acquisition of skills. - The underlying philosophy ties truth, goodness, and beauty to knowable realities, indicating a teleological view of education consistent with classical aims.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, telos, classical, great conversation, love of learning. Presence of explicit formation goals and virtue-centric language is strong. (From Six Essential Elements: formation; virtue; truth, goodness, beauty; great conversations; formation through faith and reason.) - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no emphasis on secular instrumentation, job-readiness vying against virtue formation).

Why this rating - The school's mission and public statements foreground formation, virtue, and a transcendent aims—core Classical markers for Element 2. The combination of “formation” language and explicit virtue-centric goals supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly built on liberal-arts foundations: the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium elements are named as foundational, with a liberal-arts bedrock described in the materials. This mirrors classical curriculum design. - There is explicit reference to Great Books and historical engagement as part of the curriculum, with an emphasis on “Great Books,” “great conversation,” and a historically grounded approach. The site discusses integrated humanities (Literature, History, Philosophy, Theology, and Arts) with deep engagement with limited key texts. - Latin instruction and other classical language study are described, reinforcing the Trivium emphasis and classical training. The site discusses Latin as a vehicle for mental training and access to Western heritage, consistent with classical curricula. - The curriculum is described as block-style humanities integration (Integrated Humanities) with the aim of forming “true humanity” through study of timeless texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium; Quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history; literature; philosophy; theology; sacred tradition; formation through reading of classical texts; living books; integration. (From Six Essential Elements: Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; integration; wonder; classical canon; literature; theology.) □filecite□turn0file16□turn0file1□ - Negative keywords: Not present; no major modernist, skills-based, or fragmented-curriculum signals in the public copy.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently align with classical curriculum design (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, integrated humanities, formation via timeless texts). This satisfies CLASSICAL in Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy is described as integrated, with block-format humanities and a focus on deep, extended interaction with key texts, suggesting a disciplined, contemplative, and rigorous approach. The materials emphasize formation through engagement with central texts and cross-disciplinary integration. - The site mentions a lower-to-upper school progression with different modes of engagement, including memory-focused review, early-stage forms of engagement, and later Socratic-like inquiry (though explicit Socratic language is less visible in the site copy). The public materials imply a progression toward higher-order discussion in secondary years but do not consistently spell out Socratic seminars or explicit rhetoric-training in the copy. - The presence of a structured, “Integrated Humanities” approach signals a thoughtful pedagogy that emphasizes cross-subject coherence and contemplation of great texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: integration; contemplation; wonder; Great Books; meaning of texts; memory and memorization (implied in recitation-like traditions); block format; living books; formation through arts; classical pedagogy; dialectic/rhetoric (present in the curriculum context). (From Six Essential Elements: Scholé/restful learning; Great Books; integrated approach; wonder; memory; Socratic dialogue; rhetoric; living books.) - Negative keywords found: explicit absence of detailed, explicit Socratic seminars or formal “Scholé” practice statements in the site copy. The public copy leans more to program descriptions than to explicit classroom-method definitions. This signals SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in Pedagogy.

Why this rating - The pedagogy shows many classical markers (integrated, formation-focused, memory/wonder, block-format humanities) but lacks explicit, consistent public-text references to foundational pedagogical techniques like frequent Socratic seminars or explicit Scholé-like restfulness described in detail. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is appropriate for Element 4.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site features a “Faculty” section in the navigation, signaling a defined faculty body and a living curriculum through teachers. The public copy emphasizes teachers as mentors who model virtue and helps frame the mission of forming virtuous lives, which is a classical expectation. - The mission statements describe the teacher’s role as central to the educational project, consistent with the classical model of the faculty as the living curriculum and core of the school.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: living curriculum; faculty as mentors; model teachers; core of the school; teacher as guide; virtuous instruction; wisdom; formation. (From Six Essential Elements: living curriculum; mentor; teacher as model; character formation; classical teacher ideals.) - Negative keywords: None detected in public materials (no evidence of a purely didactic or non-mentoring faculty model).

Why this rating - The presence of a dedicated Faculty section and mission-driven language about teachers as virtuous mentors and as the core of the school supports CLASSICAL for Element 5. The public materials align with the expectation that faculty embody and transmit the classical curriculum. □file-cite□turn0file0□turn0file10□

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site highlights partnerships with families and parental engagement as part of the classical education ethos. There are parent-facing resources and portals, explicit mentions of parental involvement, and a community-focused mission. - The public materials describe parents as co-educators and emphasize forming affections and transmitting cultural heritage, aligning with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” from the Six Essential Elements.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: Partnership with Families; parent cooperation; co-educators; family involvement; home-school partnership; formation of affections; love of learning; wonder; moral imagination; cultural transmission; Western heritage. (From Six Essential Elements: Partnership with Families; Formation of Affections; Cultural Transmission.) - Negative keywords: None detected; no hint of limited parent access or separation from family engagement in the public copy. (Public copy emphasizes open parent involvement.)

Why this rating - The public materials present parents as engaged, co-educators with access to portals and content, and emphasize formation of affections and cultural transmission—classic markers of CLASSICAL in Element 6. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file4□

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy) would most strengthen the overall CLASSICAL rating if explicitly articulated as a Scholé-informed pedagogy. Concrete steps:
 - Publicly document and emphasize explicit Socratic seminars or dialectical discussions in upper grades, with examples of topics and assessment methods.
 - Clearly describe the memory/recitation routines (Scholé) in lower grades with daily/weekly rhythms, songs, chants, and review cycles—and how they tie to long-term retention of Great Books and core texts.
 - Publish a concise pedagogy guide that links Trivium/Quadrivium aims to daily classroom practice and how upper-grade rhetoric and public speaking are taught (e.g., formal speech opportunities, debates, and rhetoric exercises).
 - Increase explicit mention of ancient-language and classical reasoning methods across all grades with examples of classroom exercises and student outputs that demonstrate Trivium progression.
- Additional moves (optional but beneficial):
 - Provide more explicit evidence of Great Books readings across subject areas with a published reading list and assessment rubrics to demonstrate the Great Conversation in action.
 - Expand parent-facing explanations of how the living curriculum functions in practice, with samples of student work illustrating the “formation through the arts” and “living books” approach.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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